

CANDY DIALOGUE CREATOR

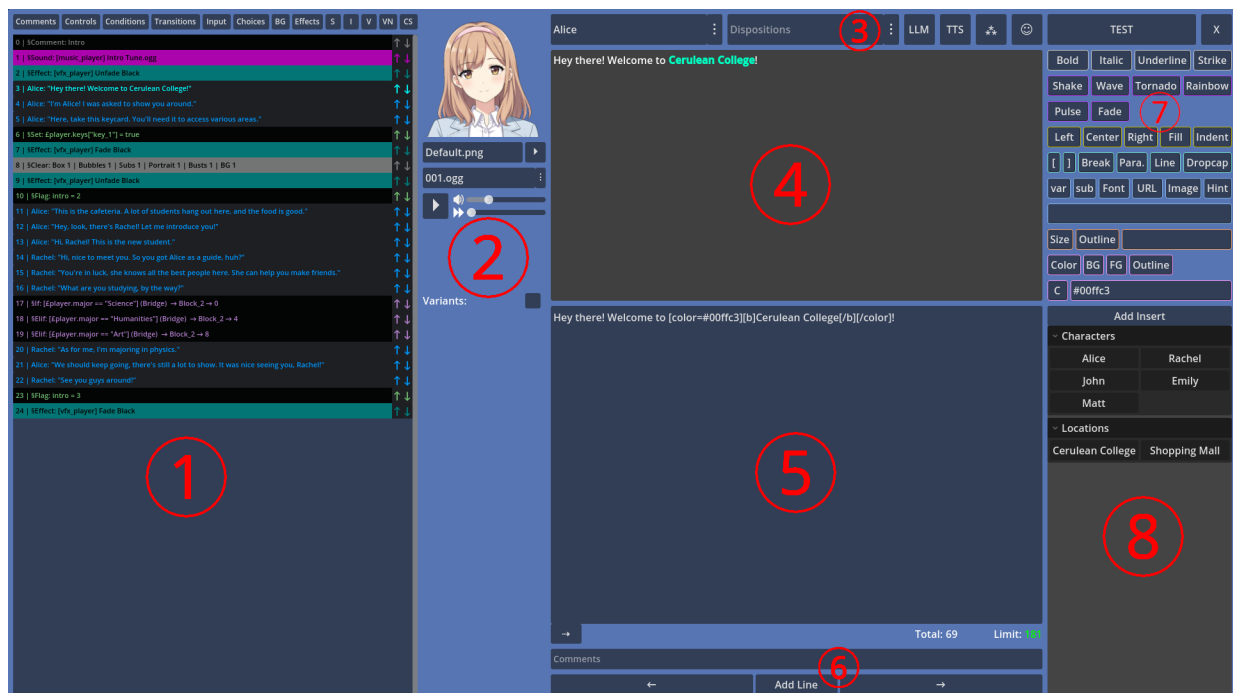
Writer UI

1.0.0

The Writer UI provides specialized features for editing Spoken Line comfortably. It can be accessed from the Main UI by clicking the  button in any Spoken Line.

Features

The Writer UI is composed of the following elements:



1. Line Overview

This panel displays all the Spoken and Command Lines in the current Block.

Lines can be reordered, and Spoken Lines can be selected by clicking on them. Specific categories can be hidden, using the filter buttons at the top.

Reordering lines is done by clicking the up and down arrow buttons next to a line. Several keyboard shortcuts are available for faster re-ordering:

CTRL + Click:

Move by 2 slots.

SHIFT + Click:

Move by 3 slots.

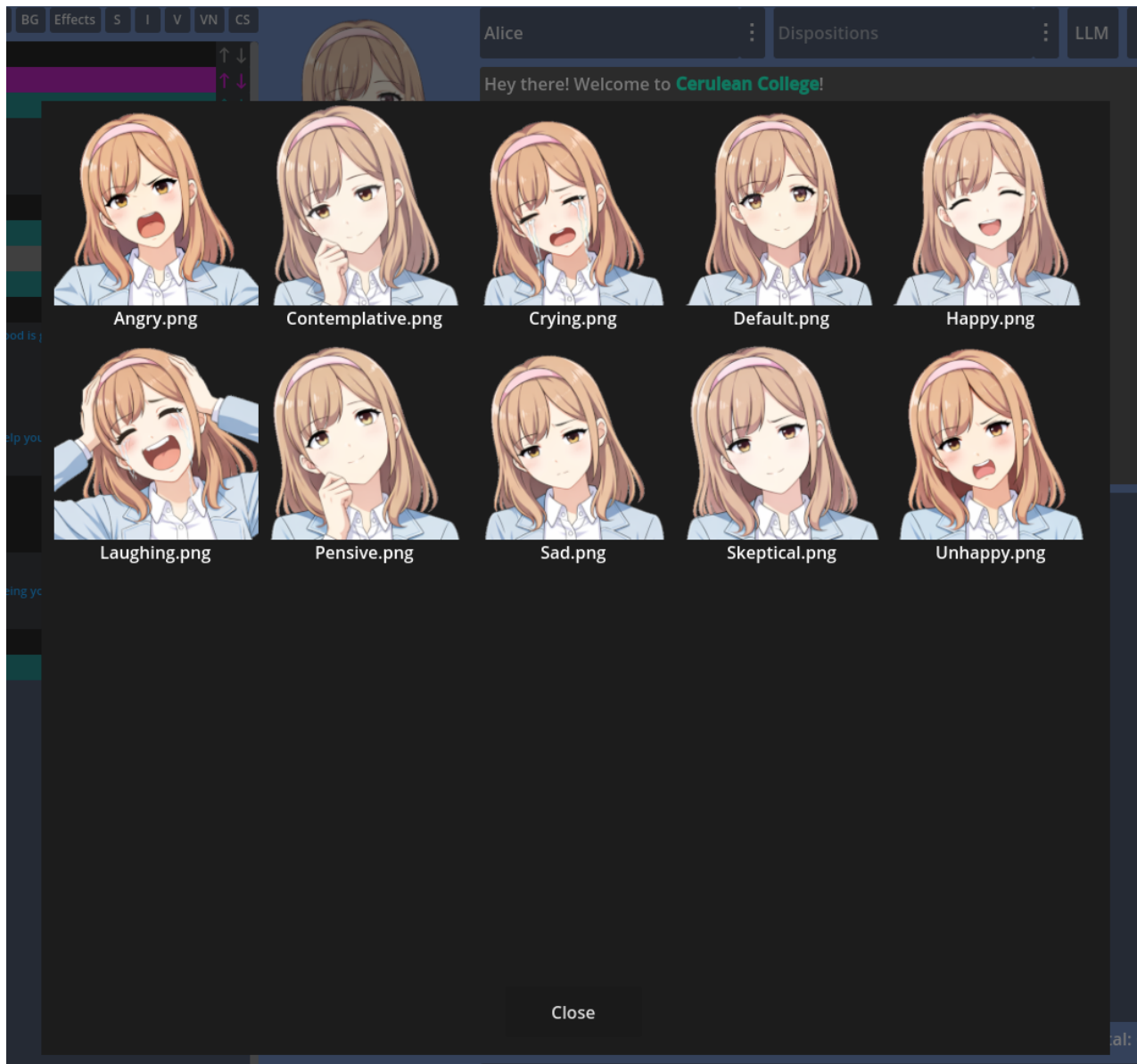
ALT + CLick:	Move by 5 slots.
CTRL + SHIFT + Click:	Move by 10 slots.
CTRL + ALT + Click:	Move by 25 slots.
SHIFT + ALT + Click:	Move by 100 slots.
CTRL + SHIFT + ALT + Click:	Move by 250 slots.

2. Left Margin

This margin allows you to select and preview a portrait for the Speaker, as well as a voice file.

If no portrait file is provided, the portrait frame will display the "Default.png" file for the Speaker (this is also what Candy Dialogue Engine does at runtime, when a line has no portrait specified).

To select a different portrait, you can either type its name in the portrait field, or click the portrait. If an actor reference is provided as the Speaker for the line, this will display all available portraits in a grid.



If there are no portraits for the actor reference, or if a role or no reference at all is provided, the grid will be empty.

Voice files assigned to a line can be previewed (and paused) by clicking the play button. The sliders next to it allow adjusting the volume and skipping ahead or rewinding.

Finally, variant display can be toggled on or off.

3. Top Area

The top area is where you can assign a Speaker to the line, and Disposition conditions. You can also toggle the LLM, TTS and Portrait tags.

The "Test" button exports the dialogue to a test file, just like the "Test" button in the Main UI.

4. Preview Area

The preview area displays the spoken text as it would appear with BBCode formatting.

At this time, the preview doesn't support custom Candy DE formatting, such as variables or word substitution.

5. Writing Area

The writing area allows you to write spoken text.

The '→' button in the bottom-left corner allows toggling the writing direction for the line, for the Default variant.

Two counters indicate the total number of characters for the line, and the number of characters below/above the chosen limit, which is helpful when spoken text must avoid exceeding a certain length. The limit value can be customized in the Settings Menu.

6. Bottom Area

The bottom area allows you to write and read comments associated to the line.

It also features a button to add a Spoken Line to the current Block for convenience, enabling you to write full dialogues without exiting the Writer UI, and buttons to navigate to the next or previous line.

7. BBCode Inserts

This area features multiple buttons to quickly insert BBCode tags. Buttons are color-coded for quicker identification.

Text fields are provided, where you can write values or properties that you want to be automatically inserted inside the tags.

For example, if you write "blue" in the color text field, then click the 'Color' button, it will insert the tags [color=blue][[/color].

Note that tags are inserted in the last focused text input area, not necessarily the writing area.

You can insert tags around a word or a string of words by highlighting the word or string before clicking a BBCode insert button.

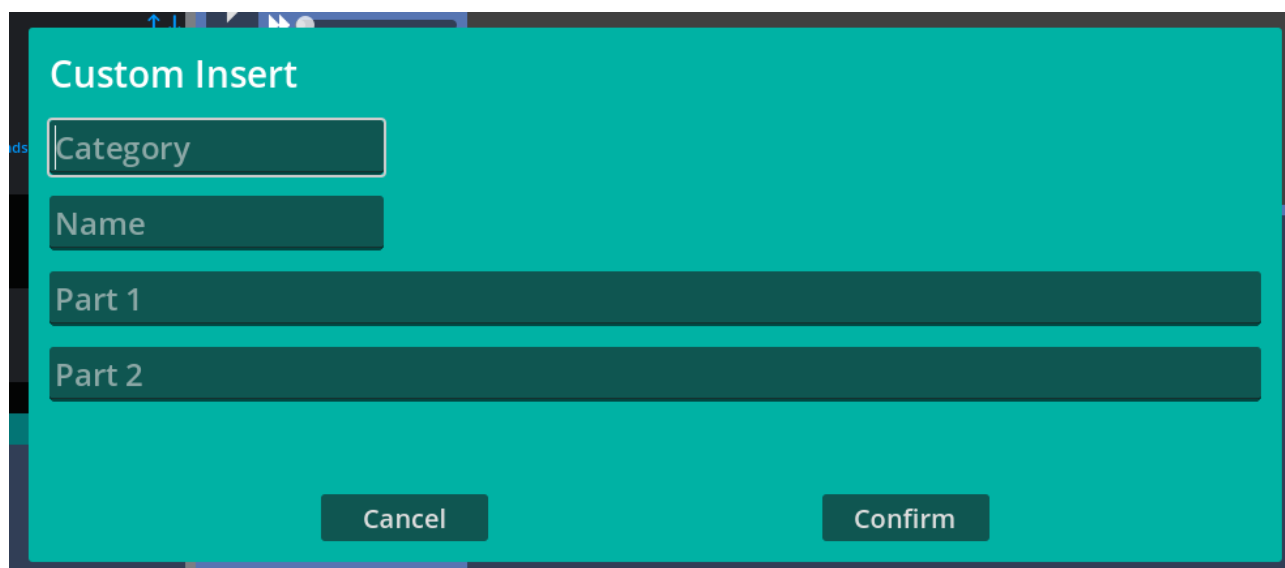
The 'var' button inserts the symbols your project uses for displaying variables in spoken lines -- default: {} }

The 'sub' button inserts the symbols your project uses for word substitution in spoken lines -- default: • ' •

The var and sub symbols can be set in the Settings Menu, and even read and imported directly from your project.

8. Custom Inserts

The custom insert area allows you to create buttons for quickly inserting any text of your choosing in the last focused text input area.

A screenshot of a 'Custom Insert' dialog box. The dialog has a teal background and a dark border. It contains four input fields: 'Category' (with a placeholder text 'Category'), 'Name' (with a placeholder text 'Name'), 'Part 1' (with a placeholder text 'Part 1'), and 'Part 2' (with a placeholder text 'Part 2'). At the bottom, there are two buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Confirm'.

Buttons can be assigned to custom categories for convenient sorting (Category input field), and can be given a custom name (Name input field).

Custom inserts can be split into two parts if you wish. Like BBCode inserts, you can wrap both parts of a custom insert around a selected word or string of words. If such splitting is never needed, write the entire text to insert in either the 'Part 1' input field, and leave 'Part 2' empty.

Variant Tools

When variant tools are enabled, several elements appear in the UI:



1. Variant Voice Preview

These controls allow previewing the voice file associated to the currently selected variant.

2. Variant Filters

For filtering the variant list.

3. Variant List

Displays a list of available variants, which can be selected by clicking them.

Variants are created in the Settings Menu.

The dot/circle button next to each variant enables or disables the given variant for the given Spoken Line.

Enabling a variant will add it to the line's data if the line doesn't already have it.

Disabling a variant does not remove it from the line, it only marks it as disabled for the given line. Disabled variants can later be removed from all lines in the Settings Menu.

4. Variant Preview Area

Displays a preview of the spoken text for the selected variant, with BBCode formatting.

Located below the Default text preview, for quick comparison.

5. Variant Writing Area

The area where you write spoken text for the selected variant. Located directly under the Default writing area, for quick reading while translating.